

Instruction Manual: Implementing a 2D Max Pooling Layer (MaxPool2d)

1 Overview of 2D Max Pooling

A 2D max pooling layer reduces the spatial dimensions of an input tensor by taking the maximum value over a specified window (kernel) for each channel, commonly used in convolutional neural networks (CNNs) to downsample feature maps. This manual provides a step-by-step guide to implement a `MaxPool2d` layer, including forward and backward passes. The implementation is non-trainable (no learnable parameters) and does not support dilation.

1.1 Key Parameters

- **Input Tensor:** Shape $[B, C, H, W]$ (denoted X), where B is batch size, C is channels, H is height, W is width.
- **Output Tensor:** Shape $[B, C, H_{\text{out}}, W_{\text{out}}]$ (denoted Y).
- **Kernel Size:** (k_h, k_w) , height and width of the pooling window.
- **Stride:** (s_h, s_w) , step size for sliding the window.
- **Padding:** Options: “valid” (no padding) or custom $(p_{\text{left}}, p_{\text{right}}, p_{\text{top}}, p_{\text{bottom}})$.
- **Padding Mode:** “zero” (zero-padding).
- **Layer Name:** String identifier (default “MaxPool2D”).

1.2 Assumptions

- Tensors are 4D with dimensions $[B, C, H, W]$.
- No dilation is supported (fixed at $(1, 1)$).
- The layer is non-trainable (no weights or biases).

2 Mathematical Formulation

2.1 Forward Pass

The forward pass computes Y by taking the maximum value over a kernel window in X for each position. For $Y[b, c, oh, ow]$:

$$Y[b, c, oh, ow] = \max_{\substack{0 \leq kh < k_h \\ 0 \leq kw < k_w}} X[b, c, ih + kh, iw + kw] \quad (1)$$

Where:

- $ih = oh \cdot s_h - p_{\text{top}}$
- $iw = ow \cdot s_w - p_{\text{left}}$

The operation is applied independently for each batch b and channel c . During the forward pass, the indices of the maximum values are cached for use in the backward pass.

2.1.1 Output Dimensions

$$H_{\text{out}} = \left\lfloor \frac{H + p_{\text{top}} + p_{\text{bottom}} - k_h}{s_h} \right\rfloor + 1 \quad (2)$$

$$W_{\text{out}} = \left\lfloor \frac{W + p_{\text{left}} + p_{\text{right}} - k_w}{s_w} \right\rfloor + 1 \quad (3)$$

2.2 Backward Pass

The backward pass computes the gradient $\frac{\partial L}{\partial X}$ given $\frac{\partial L}{\partial Y}$ (denoted

2.3 Class Structure

The `MaxPool2d` class includes:

- **Attributes:** Channels, kernel size, stride, padding, layer name, input/output caches, max indices cache.
- **Methods:** Constructor, `forward`, `backward`, helpers (`pad_input`,

2.4 Constructor

Algorithm 1 MaxPool2d Constructor

```

1: function MaxPool2d(kernel_size=(2,2), stride=(2,2), padding=(2,2), padding_mode="valid", num_padding=(0,0,0,0), padding_mode="zero", layer_name="MaxPool2D")
   if kernel_size[0] ≤ 0 or kernel_size[1] ≤ 0 then
2:   throw "Kernel size must be positive"
3:
4:
5:   if stride[0] ≤ 0 or stride[1] ≤ 0 then
6:     throw "Stride must be positive"
7:   end if
8:   if padding ∉ ["valid"] then
9:     throw "Only valid padding is supported"
10:  end if
11:  if padding_mode ≠ "zero" then
12:    throw "Only zero-padding is supported"
13:  end if
14:  if num_padding[0, 1, 2, 3] i 0 then throw "Padding values must be non-negative"
15:  function
16:    this.kernel_size ← kernel_size      this.stride ← stride
17:    this.padding ← padding
18:    this.num_padding ← num_padding      this.padding_mode ← padding_mode
19:    this.layer_name ← layer_name or "MaxPool2D" end function = 0
20:
21:
22:

```

2.5 Padding

Algorithm 2 Pad Input

```

23: function pad_input(X)
   p_left, p_right, p_top, p_bottom ← num_padding
24:   function p_left = 0 and p_right = 0 and p_top = 0 and p_bottom = 0
25:     return X
26:
27:   B, C, H, W ← X.shape
28:   padded_X ← zeros(shape=[B, C, H + p_top + p_bottom, W + p_left + p_right])
29:   padded_X[:, :, p_top : (H + p_top), p_left : (W + p_left)] ← X
30:   return padded_X end function

```

2.6 Output Dimensions

Algorithm 3 Initialize Output

```

10: function init_output X   B, C, H, W  $\leftarrow$  X.shape
11:    $k_h, k_w \leftarrow \text{kernel\_size}$     $s_h, s_w \leftarrow \text{stride}$ 
12:    $p_{\text{top}}, p_{\text{bottom}}, p_{\text{left}}, p_{\text{right}} \leftarrow \text{num\_padding}$     $out_h \leftarrow \lfloor (H + p_{\text{top}} + p_{\text{bottom}} - k_h) / s_h \rfloor + 1$ 
13:    $out_w \leftarrow \lfloor (W + p_{\text{left}} + p_{\text{right}} - k_w) / s_w \rfloor + 1$ 
14:   if  $out_h \leq 0$  or  $out_w \leq 0$  then
15:     throw "Invalid output dimensions"
16:   end if
17:   output  $\leftarrow \text{zeros}(\text{shape}=[B, C, out_h, out_w])$    return  $out_h, out_w$ 
18: function

```

2.7 Forward Pass

Algorithm 4 Forward Pass

```

1: function forward X
2:   in_cache  $\leftarrow$  X
3:   B, C, H, W  $\leftarrow$  X.shape
4:   input_padded  $\leftarrow \text{pad\_input}(X)$     $out_h, out_w \leftarrow \text{init\_output}(X)$ 
5:   output  $\leftarrow \text{zeros}(\text{shape}=[B, C, out_h, out_w])$    max_indices  $\leftarrow \text{zeros}(\text{shape}=[B, C,$ 
6:    $out_h, out_w, 2])$ 
7:   for b in 0 to B - 1
8:     for c in 0 to C - 1 do
9:       for oh in 0 to  $out_h - 1$  do
10:        for ow in 0 to  $out_w - 1$  do
11:          for i do  $start \leftarrow oh \cdot s_h - p_{\text{top}}$ 
12:             $iw_{start} \leftarrow ow \cdot s_w - p_{\text{left}}$ 
13:             $max\_val \leftarrow -\infty$ 
14:             $max\_idx \leftarrow [0, 0]$ 
15:            for kh in 0 to  $k_h - 1$  do
16:              for kw in 0 to  $k_w - 1$  do
17:                 $ih \leftarrow i_{start} + kh$ 
18:                 $iw \leftarrow iw_{start} + kw$ 
19:                 $ih \geq 0$  and  $ih < H + p_{\text{top}} + p_{\text{bottom}}$  and  $iw \geq 0$  and  $iw < W + p_{\text{left}} + p_{\text{right}}$ 
20:                  val  $\leftarrow \text{input\_padded}[b, c, ih, iw]$    if  $val > max\_val$  then
21:                     $max\_val \leftarrow val$ 
22:                     $max\_idx \leftarrow [kh, kw]$ 
23:
24:
25:
26:
27:             end for
28:           end for
29:           output[b, c, oh, ow]  $\leftarrow max\_val$    max_indices[b, c, oh, ow]  $\leftarrow$ 
30:            $max\_idx$ 
31:
32:
33:
34:
35:           this.max_indices  $\leftarrow max\_indices$    return output
36:           =0

```

2.8 Backward Pass

3 Example Usage

```

25: pool = MaxPool2d(

```

Algorithm 5 Backward Pass

```
1: function backwardgradout   if gradout.shape ≠ [B, C, outh, outw] then
3:   functionthrow "Gradient output dimensions mismatch"
4:
5:    $B, C, H, W \leftarrow \text{in\_cache.shape}$    gradinput ← zeros(shape=[B, C, H, W])
6:   inputpadded ← padinput(incache)   for bin0toB-1 do
9:    $c$  in 0 to  $C - 1$ 
10:  for oh in 0 to outh-1 do           for owin0tooutw-1 do
12:    for i do  $ih_{start} \leftarrow oh \cdot s_h - p_{top}$ 
13:     $iw_{start} \leftarrow ow \cdot s_w - p_{left}$ 
14:     $[kh, kw] \leftarrow \text{max\_indices}[b, c, oh, ow]$     $ih \leftarrow ih_{start} + kh$ 
16:     $iw \leftarrow iw_{start} + kw$    if  $ih \geq 0$  and  $ih < H + p_{top} + p_{bottom}$  and
     $iw \geq 0$  and  $iw < W + p_{left} + p_{right}$  then
18:      gradinput[ $b, c, ih - p_{top}, iw - p_{left}$ ] ← gradout[ $b, c, oh, ow$ ]
19:
20:
21:
22:
23:
24:   return gradinput = 0
```

```
    kernel_size=(2,2), stride=(2,2), padding="valid",
    num_padding=(0,0,0,0), layer_name="MaxPool2D"
)
X = random_tensor(shape=[batch_size, 3, 28, 28])
Y = pool.forward(X)
grad_out = random_tensor(shape=Y.shape)
grad_input = pool.backward(grad_out)
```

4 Error Handling

- Validate input dimensions and parameters.
- Check for non-integer or negative output dimensions.
- Ensure gradient shape matches input shape.

5 Optimization Tips

- Use vectorized operations for max computations if supported by the language.
- Cache input and max indices to avoid redundant computations.
- Parallelize loops for large inputs.